

ACIDIFY

USER MANUAL

VERSION 2.17.4



CONTENTS

01	Panel Overview	3
02	Sound Controls	4
03	Clock and Transport	5
04	MIDI Input: What Plays When	7
05	Programming Patterns: CLASSIC Editor	8
06	STUDIO Editor	10
07	ARP Editor	11
08	CIRCUIT MODS Overlay (MOD button)	12
09	DISTORTION Overlay (DIST button)	13
10	Global Controls and Gestures	14

1

Red numbers on the screenshots match the numbers in the tables on the same page.

01

PANEL OVERVIEW

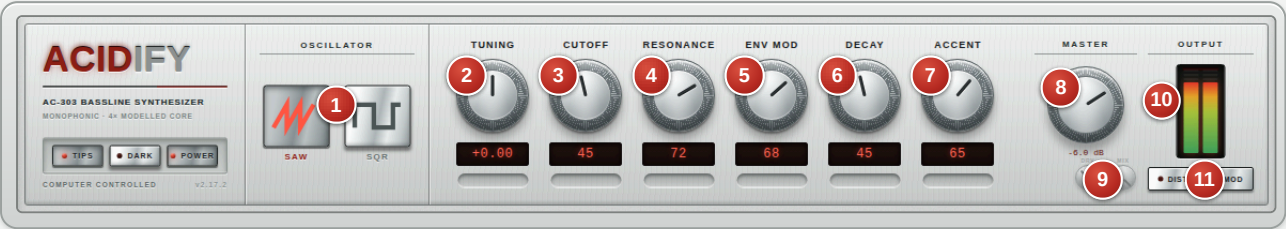


ZONE	WHAT IT IS
1 Top left	Logo, TIPS / DARK / POWER buttons
2 OSCILLATOR	SAW / SQR waveform switch
3 Knob row	TUNING, CUTOFF, RESONANCE, ENV MOD, DECAY, ACCENT
4 MASTER / OUTPUT	Master volume, DRV/MIX mini dials, level meter, DIST and MOD buttons
5 Middle strip	TEMPO, CLOCK (INT / DAW / RUN), GRID, PLAY MODE, SWING, LENGTH, ROOT, FILTER RESPONSE display
6 Bottom	16 STEP PATTERN PROGRAMMER with three editors: CLASSIC, STUDIO, ARP

The three editor tabs at the top right of the programmer (CLASSIC / STUDIO / ARP) switch the bottom section. Click the tab you want, or press **M** to cycle. Everything else on the panel stays the same in all three views.

02

SOUND CONTROLS



CONTROL	FUNCTION
1 SAW / SQR	Selects the oscillator waveform, sawtooth or square. Same two flavors as the original unit.
2 TUNING	Master tune, ± 1 semitone around center.
3 CUTOFF	Filter cutoff. This sets the <i>resting point</i> of the filter. Notes still open the filter above it when ENV MOD is up (see below).
4 RESONANCE	Filter resonance. Full clockwise sits just under self-oscillation, like a stock unit.
5 ENV MOD	How much the filter envelope pushes the cutoff up on each note. Important: more ENV MOD also pulls the resting cutoff down between notes. That is original 303 circuit behavior, not a bug. If you want to hear the filter fully closed, turn ENV MOD down as well as CUTOFF.
6 DECAY	Filter envelope decay time, 200 ms to 2.5 s. On accented steps the decay is always fixed at the short 200 ms setting, exactly like the hardware.
7 ACCENT	How hard accented steps hit: louder through the VCA and an extra resonance-dependent filter sweep. At high RESONANCE the accent sweep gets faster and more aggressive.
8 MASTER	Output volume, -36 to $+6$ dB. Sits after the distortion stage, so it never changes the distortion character.
9 DRV / MIX minis	Direct access to the distortion Drive and Mix without opening the overlay.
10 OUTPUT meter	Peak meter with clip latch. If the red clip indicator lights, click it to reset.
11 DIST / MOD buttons	Open the Distortion and Circuit Mods overlays (sections 8 and 9).

The FILTER RESPONSE display in the middle strip shows the current filter curve plus live readouts of RES, ENV, DEC and ACC.

03

CLOCK AND TRANSPORT



The small **INT / DAW** switch in the CLOCK cell selects the clock source; **RUN** sits next to it.

INT MODE

The internal clock runs the sequencer. Set the tempo with the TEMPO knob (mouse wheel = 0.1 BPM steps, hold Shift for 0.01) and start/stop with **RUN**.

DAW MODE

● DAW TRANSPORT

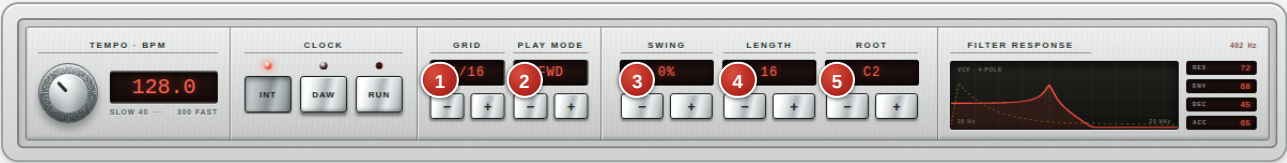
In DAW mode the sequencer starts and stops with your DAW's transport. Press play in the DAW to make ACIDIFY play. The RUN button switches to FOLLOW and the tempo knob mirrors the host tempo; both are read-only while the host is in control.

Notes on DAW mode:

- In FWD play mode the pattern locks to the DAW's song position: bar 1 beat 1 is step 1, and jumping the playhead in the DAW jumps the pattern with it. The other play modes (REV, pendulum, INVERT, RND) advance one step per grid tick instead, since they have no fixed song-position mapping.
- If the host does not deliver transport information at all, RUN and TEMPO keep working as a manual fallback so the instrument is never dead.
- Switching back to INT keeps the last host tempo as the new internal tempo.

CONTINUED

GRID, PLAY MODE, SWING, LENGTH, ROOT



CONTROL	FUNCTION
1 GRID	Step length: 1/32, 1/16T, 1/16., 1/16, 1/8T, 1/8., 1/8, 1/4T, 1/4., 1/4, 1/2, 1/1, 2/1, 3/1
2 PLAY MODE	Step order: FWD, REV, FWD&REV (pendulum), INVERT (outside-in), RND (random, never the same step twice in a row)
3 SWING	0–100 %. Delays every second step; at 100 % the pair splits 2/3 + 1/3 (full triplet feel). Works in INT and DAW mode.
4 LENGTH	Pattern length, 1–16 steps. Steps beyond the length are shown disabled.
5 ROOT	Root note of the pattern (C1–C4). All step pitches are relative to this.

04

MIDI INPUT: WHAT PLAYS WHEN

This is the part that confuses everyone once, so here is the whole rule set:

SITUATION	WHAT MIDI NOTES DO
Sequencer stopped (RUN off, or DAW transport stopped)	MIDI notes play directly, like a mono synth. Velocity 100 or higher triggers an accent. Playing legato (new note while holding the old one) slides between the notes.
Sequencer running, CLASSIC or STUDIO editor	MIDI notes are ignored . The 16-step pattern is the only note source, exactly like the original 303. Program the pattern instead of playing it.
Sequencer running, ARP editor	MIDI notes feed the arpeggiator: hold a chord and the arp plays it. The pattern still provides the rhythm: its gates, accents and slides act as a step mask, only the pitches come from your chord.
Any time	MIDI CC 120 / CC 123 = all notes off.

 NO SOUND ON MIDI?

So: if you send ACIDIFY notes and hear nothing, check whether the sequencer is running while you are in CLASSIC or STUDIO. Either stop the transport to play live, or switch to ARP to play into the running sequence.

05

PROGRAMMING PATTERNS: CLASSIC EDITOR



The step row is always visible. Each of the 16 steps has:

- 1 a **gate button** (lit = the step plays, dark = rest),
- 2 an **A pill** (accent) and an **S pill** (slide) directly above it,
- 3 a **pitch readout** below it.

Direct actions on a step:

ACTION	RESULT
Click	Select the step for editing
Double-click	Toggle the gate (note/rest)
Mouse wheel	Change pitch in semitones
Right-click	Note picker menu
Click A / S pill	Toggle accent / slide for that step

CONTINUED



The editor below shows the selected step. Use the **1** **KEYBOARD** to set its pitch, and the buttons on the right:

BUTTON	FUNCTION
2 OCT - / OCT +	Transpose the selected step one octave down/up
3 GATE	Toggle note/rest
4 ACCENT	Toggle accent (louder + filter bite)
5 SLIDE	Ties this step to the next: the note holds through the step and glides into the next pitch. This is the classic 303 slide.
6 CLEAR	Reset the step

Slide behavior detail: a slide on step N makes step N run at full length and glide into step N+1. Without slide, each note plays half the step length, then releases.

06

STUDIO EDITOR



The same pattern as a matrix, for fast editing:

- 1 **ACCENT / SLIDE lanes** – click cells to toggle. Drag to paint several steps in one stroke.
- 2 **BASS LINE lane** – the pitch contour. Mouse wheel on a cell changes its pitch; right-click opens the note picker.
- 3 **PITCH GATE lane** – gates plus pitch readouts, same interactions as the classic step row.

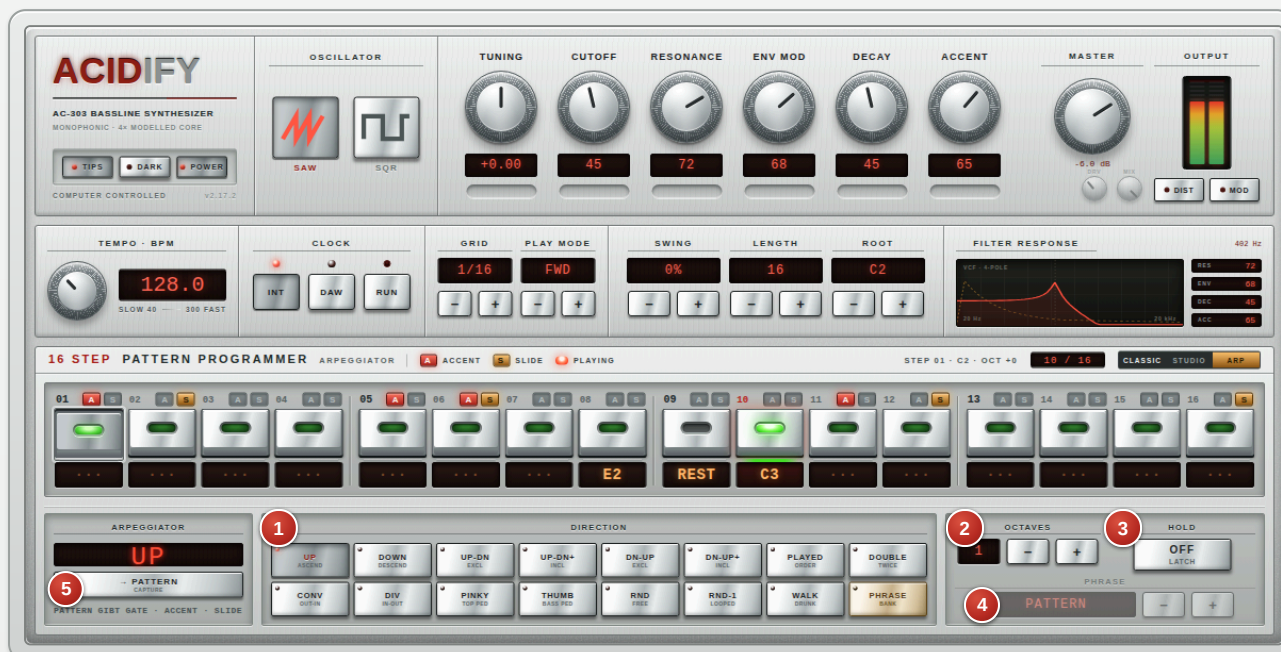
Multi-select: drag across cells, then use the tool panel on the right:

GROUP	TOOLS
4 EDIT	UNDO, REDO, COPY, PASTE (keyboard shortcuts work too)
5 ARRANGE	ROTATE left/right, REVERSE the pattern, MIRROR the pitches
6 SELECTED STEP	-12 / +12 octave, REST, NOTE picker
7 GENERATE	PHRASE (writes a phrase from the acid bank into the pattern), MUTATE (varies the current pattern), SCALE (pick the scale used for generation, e.g. MIN PENTA), 16/ALL (apply range)

Hold Shift while dragging any value for fine control.

07

ARP EDITOR



Switch to ARP, start the sequencer, and **hold notes or a chord on your MIDI keyboard** – the arpeggiator plays them in the selected figure. The step row still runs the show rhythmically: gates, accents and slides come from the pattern, pitches come from your hand.

CONTROL	FUNCTION
1 DIRECTION	16 figures: UP, DOWN, UP-DN (exclusive), UP-DN+ (inclusive), DN-UP, DN-UP+, PLAYED (in the order you pressed them), DOUBLE (every note twice), CONV (outside-in), DIV (inside-out), PINKY (top note between every note), THUMB (bottom note between every note), RND, RND-1 (one random draw, then looped), WALK (random neighbor steps), PHRASE
2 OCTAVES	Extends your held notes over 1–4 octaves
3 HOLD	Latch: keep playing after you release the keys. Press new keys to replace the chord.
4 PHRASE	In PHRASE mode: bank selector. “PATTERN” (position 0) plays your own pattern’s pitches transposed by the held key; positions 1–90 play the built-in acid phrase bank, transposed by the held key.
5 → PATTERN (capture)	Copies the currently playing phrase into your own 16-step pattern, so you can edit it in CLASSIC or STUDIO.

The display above shows the current figure and the note currently played by the arp.

CIRCUIT MODS OVERLAY (MOD BUTTON)



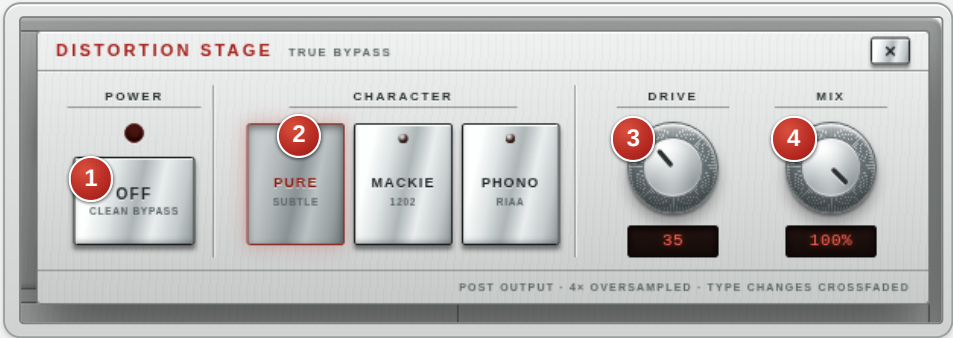
Six famous hardware modifications, each one a real component change from the Devil Fish and x0x mod documentation. Every mod has its own ON/OFF switch, so the plugin is a bone-stock 303 until you flip something. Defaults = stock.

MOD	EFFECT
1 OVERDRIVE	Filter input overdrive (R62 220k → 3k3). Amount sets the drive factor up to ~66×. The filter itself starts to growl.
2 RESO BOOST	x0x resonance mod (R97 10k → 8k2): feedback ×1.22, pushes the filter into self-oscillation territory.
3 CUTOFF RANGE	Raises the cutoff ceiling from 2.5 kHz to 5 kHz.
4 ENV MOD ×3	Triples the envelope modulation range.
5 SLIDE TIME	Puts a pot in series with the slide circuit: slide time 22–132 ms instead of fixed 22 ms.
6 SOFT ATTACK	Replaces the hardware's snappy attack (and its ~4 ms gate delay) with an adjustable 0.5–30 ms ramp.

Close the overlay with the X button, Escape, or a click outside.

09

DISTORTION OVERLAY (DIST BUTTON)



Post-filter drive stage, 4× oversampled, true bypass when off.

CONTROL	FUNCTION
1 POWER	Enable / clean bypass
2 CHARACTER	PURE – subtle level-dependent saturation. MACKIE – modeled mixer-preamp crunch. PHONO – the 90s trick: a 303 plugged into the phono input of a home amplifier, RIAA curve and all. From warm to fully blown out.
3 DRIVE	Amount of drive for the selected character
4 MIX	Dry/wet blend

All three characters are loudness-matched to the clean signal, so switching characters or turning Drive does not jump your level. Type changes are crossfaded – you can switch while playing.

Note: the distortion sits *after* the filter. Harmonics it creates are not affected by CUTOFF.

GLOBAL CONTROLS AND GESTURES

CONTROL	FUNCTION
1 TIPS	Tooltips on/off. With TIPS on, hovering any control shows exactly what it does — the fastest way to learn the panel.
2 DARK	Switches between the silver and anthracite look.
3 POWER	Full plugin bypass.

GESTURE	WORKS ON
Mouse wheel	Every knob, display, step and matrix cell
Shift + drag / Shift + wheel	Fine adjustment everywhere
Double-click on a step	Gate toggle
Right-click on a step or cell	Note picker
M	Cycle CLASSIC → STUDIO → ARP
Escape	Close overlays

